



AKC CGC Prep

CGC Skill 4 · Loose Leash Tracker



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Loose Leash Walking

Master cgc item 4.

Walk a short course with your dog on your left, showing a mostly loose leash without pulling, lagging, or forging ahead — the foundation for Items 4 and 5.

TRAINER NOTE

CGC prep is about reliable real-life manners — not perfection under pressure. Practice below threshold, log your reps,

Start here

Dog's name

Target test date

Handler name

Best reward

Know the criteria

Handler and dog walk a course.

Dog need not be on exact heel but

1 **Official skill criteria**
must show loose leash walking. Dog should be on handler's

Handler mechanics

Reward at your left hip when leash is loose.

End on success

Stop while your dog can still think, eat, and cooperate.

CGC ITEM 4

Handler and dog walk a course. Dog need not be on exact heel but must show no sustained pulling. Dog should be on handler's left with leash mostly loose.

2 **Handler checklist**

- ☐ Reward at your left hip when leash is loose.
- ☐ Stop when the leash tightens — movement is the reward.
- ☐ Short strides keep your dog beside you.
- ☐ Practice left-side position daily.

Supplies needed

- 6-ft leash
- Front-clip harness
- High-value treats



CGC PRACTICE · FITDOG

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Mark and treat when the leash hangs in a gentle U at your left side.

Walk 30 feet. Stop when the leash tightens. Restart when loose.

Practice right and left turns without yanking.

Add one mild distraction — a person sitting on a bench.

Log percentage of loose-leash steps during a 3-minute walk.

4 Common reasons dogs fail this item

- ☐ Sustained pulling
- ☐ Dog forging far ahead
- ☐ Handler yanking leash
- ☐ Dog lagging behind consistently

5 Weekly practice log

Date	Setup	Duration	Success 1–5	Notes / next step
Day 1	Easy environment	5 min		
Day 2	Add one distraction	5 min		
Day 3	Hold difficulty	5 min		
Day 4	New location	5 min		
Day 5	Review + film	5 min		

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TEST DAY · READINESS

6 Test-day readiness checklist

FITDOG TRAINER HOMEWORK

CGC walking is controlled partnership — not heel perfection, but no sustained pulling.

- ☐ Harness + 6-ft leash
- ☐ Loose leash on sidewalk yesterday
- ☐ Left-side position practiced

7 Self-score before scheduling your evaluation

Question	Yes	Not yet
Dog succeeds 4/5 reps in practice this week		
Handler can explain criteria without reading notes		
Dog can eat treats in practice environment		
No safety concerns (bite risk, panic, escape)		
Ready to schedule official CGC evaluation		

-  Schedule evaluation — stack wins look solid
-  Another 2 weeks of practice at this skill
-  Contact Fitdog for trainer support

8 Notes for your trainer or evaluator

Observation	Details
Strongest rep this week	
Hardest moment	
Equipment that helped	
Question for test day	